

Philipp Hilbert. *Trust infrastructure product manager for the agentic era.*

Positioning, a technical PM with a decade of delivery in regulated, ambiguous environments – now applying that precision to the problem of governed AI deployment.

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Dear Affinidi team,

The Trust Fabric brief maps cleanly onto a problem I have spent the last two years inside from different angles: how do you make a complex, policy-sensitive platform legible enough that real organisations can deploy it with confidence rather than caution? At Rohde & Schwarz I owned the data management platform for a multinational defence AI programme, where SafeAI and ExplainableAI were not marketing terms but contractual obligations. Every dataset that entered an ML training pipeline needed a chain of custody: where it came from, what transformations had touched it, and what the audit trail looked like when an evaluator asked. That is structurally the same problem Affinidi is solving for AI agents – verifiable identity, traceable decisions, policy guardrails that hold under production load.

What I bring to a role like this is technical depth paired with delivery discipline. At Rohde & Schwarz I worked independently enough to unblock an infrastructure-level OpenShift issue that engineers had been deferring for over a year, then shipped the feature in one week. At the Federal Employment Agency I served concurrently as product manager and Deputy IT Security Officer, which meant holding security and compliance requirements inside the product process rather than treating them as a handoff. I am comfortable in technical discussions at the architecture level – not as a passenger but as a participant who can challenge assumptions, evaluate trade-offs, and write requirements that engineers find useful rather than decorative.

The job description asks for someone who is developer-obsessed. I take that seriously. The hardest part of building developer-facing infrastructure is that your users notice everything – missing error messages, inconsistent API behaviour, docs that don't match the actual response. At Emil Group I re-established delivery credibility on an InsurTech platform by introducing structured refinement, splitting a 17-person team into focused Scrum units, and running weekly client workshops until the product felt trustworthy again. Trust is rebuilt in small, consistent

steps, not in announcements. That instinct transfers directly to Affinidi's positioning: a Trust Fabric that developers adopt because it behaves predictably is the only version that scales.

The decentralised identity space is one I have been tracking from the infrastructure side. My crypto background is hands-on – wallets, bridges, DEXes, perpetuals, cross-chain risk – and it has given me a working mental model of what happens when trust assumptions are violated and fallback mechanisms matter. The parallels to verifiable credentials and decentralised identity infrastructure are not superficial; the failure modes are structurally similar. I understand why trustless systems are hard and what it takes to make them practical for users who are not cryptographers.

Berlin is my home base, and a hybrid model that combines focused office collaboration with deep work time is exactly how I operate best.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
